

TUGRUL GUNER

AI Engineering Manager | Hands-on AI Architect | Team Builder

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PROFILE

AI engineering leader with an MBA, a Ph.D., more than five years of AI and MLOps experience, and a decade of Python expertise. I build high-performing teams and the systems around them: clear ownership, scalable architecture, fast delivery, and a culture of curiosity and accountability. I remain hands-on in prototyping, architecture, shared platforms, and production delivery while managing cross-functional teams and stakeholders at every level.

EXPERIENCE

AI Engineering Manager | Compass Digital (CDAI)

Toronto, ON | Jan 2026 - Present

- Expanded from leading one cross-functional pod to managing two pods, while increasing team delivery velocity by 2.5x.
- Launched three products, including a recommendation system that improved menu-item attachment rate by 4x.
- Remain hands-on: prototype ideas, make architectural changes, deliver production work, and build shared platforms that reduce redundancy and improve scalability.
- Started the company's AI & Science channel and continuously share developments across both fields; co-host the company-wide AI Center of Excellence meeting with the enterprise architect.
- Manage stakeholders at every level and translate business goals into technical initiatives, delivery plans, and production systems.
- Build high-performing teams around ownership, strong engineering standards, and fast delivery; initiated recurring lunches and social events to strengthen the wider culture.

Technical Manager, AI Architect | Haptiq

Toronto, ON | May 2025 - Jan 2026

- Built Haptiq's AI team and first AI infrastructure, establishing the roadmap, modular architecture, and engineering practices from the ground up.
- Recruited and led a seven-person team across ML engineering, MLOps, and backend development; created a culture of ownership, knowledge-sharing, and high performance.
- Led technical delivery and client conversations for the company's first AI product, helping sell AI solutions to companies and contributing to more than \$2M in new revenue.
- Worked directly with clients and executives to turn business needs into product direction, architecture, delivery plans, risk assessments, and performance reporting.
- Standardized reviews, documentation, release management, sprint planning, and ownership to turn a new team into a reliable delivery system.

Lead MLOps Engineer | Arteria AI

Toronto, ON | Dec 2024 - May 2025

- Architected scalable AI and backend systems aligned with business goals and integrated Ray with Kubernetes.
- Led cross-functional delivery, mentoring, cost optimization, availability, and fault-tolerance work.

Senior MLOps Engineer | Arteria AI

Toronto, ON | Sep 2022 - Dec 2024

- Automated backend systems for model integration and scaling, and built user-friendly APIs for rapid experimentation and deployment.
- Reduced Kubernetes infrastructure costs by 60% with KServe and improved model performance 10x with quantization and ONNX.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and Databricks to streamline the machine-learning lifecycle.

TECHNICAL RANGE

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash, Git | **ML:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, DSPy, vLLM

Agents: Pydantic AI, LangGraph, CrewAI, LlamaIndex, FastMCP | **MLOps:** KServe, MLflow, Ray Serve, LitServe

Platforms: AWS, Azure, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Databricks, GitHub Actions | **Systems:** FastAPI, Django, PostgreSQL, Qdrant, MongoDB, Redis, RabbitMQ

EDUCATION & RESEARCH

MBA, Quantic School of Business and Technology, 2025 | **Ph.D., Materials Science and Engineering**, Izmir Institute of Technology, 2018
30 journal publications, one patent, 1,023 Google Scholar citations, h-index 19, i10-index 21 (September 2026).

OPEN SOURCE & WRITING

Created **ModePot**, an open-source family of frameworks, tools, engines, and games focused on simpler APIs, modern runtimes, performance, and bounded agent-owned decisions. Write **Passionately Curious**, a science newsletter exploring physics, AI, and biology for broad audiences.